

operating system from <https://python.org/>. If you're having trouble installing Python, you can find more instructions at <https://installpython3.com/>.

Downloading and Installing the Mu Editor

While the Python software runs your program, you'll type the Python code into a text editor or integrated development environment (IDE) application. I recommend using Mu Editor for your IDE if you are a beginner because it's simple and doesn't distract you with an overwhelming number of advanced options.

Open <https://codewith.mu/> in your browser. On Windows and macOS, download the installer for your operating system and then run it by double-clicking the installer file. If you are on macOS, running the installer opens a window where you must drag the Mu icon to the Applications folder icon to continue the installation. If you are on Ubuntu, you'll need to install Mu as a Python package. In that case, open a new Terminal window and run `pip3 install mu-editor` to install and `mu-editor` to run it. Click the **Instructions** button in the Python Package section of the download page for full instruction details.

Running the Mu Editor

Once it's installed, let's start Mu:

- On Windows 7 or later, click the **Start** icon in the lower-left corner of your screen, enter **mu** in the search box, and select **Mu** when it appears.
- On macOS, open the Finder window, click **Applications**, and then click **mu-editor**.
- On Ubuntu, press CTRL-ALT-T to open a Terminal window and then enter `python3 -m mu`.

The first time Mu runs, a Select Mode window appears with the following options: Adafruit CircuitPython, BBC micro:bit, Pygame Zero, and Python 3. Select Python 3. You can always change the mode later by clicking the **Mode** button at the top of the editor window.

You'll be able to enter the code into Mu's main window and then save, open, and run your files from the buttons at the top.

Running IDLE and Other Editors

You can use any number of editors for writing Python code. The Integrated Development and Learning Environment (IDLE) software installs along with Python, and it can serve as a second editor if for some reason you can't get Mu installed or working. Let's start IDLE now:

- On Windows 7 or later, click the **Start** icon in the lower-left corner of your screen, enter **idle** in the search box, and select **IDLE (Python GUI)**.